

PHUONG Q. LEphuong.le@chicagobooth.edu | pqle.github.io**ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS & EDUCATION****The University of Chicago Booth School of Business**

Principal Researcher

Aug 2025-Present

University of Virginia, Frank Batten School of Leadership and Public Policy

Postdoctoral Research Associate

Aug 2024-Aug 2025

The Ohio State University

Ph.D. Psychology

Aug 2024

M.A. Psychology

Aug 2020

University at Buffalo, The State University of New York

B.A. Psychology & Social Sciences Interdisciplinary (International Studies)

Jun 2017

Minor in Geography (International Business and World Trade)

Summa cum laude; High Honors Thesis in Psychology**GRANTS, HONORS & AWARDS***University of Virginia*

Thriving Youth in a Digital Environment (TYDE) – Large Grant (\$100,000)

Apr 2025

*Digital Detox or Intentional Usage Reduction? An Examination of the Trade-offs and Consequences of Abstinence versus Moderation in Social Media Use***Lead**; co-authors: Kentaro Fujita & PI: Abigail Scholer*The Ohio State University*

Council of Graduate Students – Ray Travel Award (\$1,000)

Nov 2023

The Women's Place – Grant on Women, Gender, and Gender Equity (\$1,000)

May 2023

*Examining the Role of Female Storyteller's Visual Perspective When Sharing Experienced Sexism***Awardee**; co-authors: Stephanie A. Stewart-Hill & Lisa K. Libby

Decision Sciences Collaborative – Spring Forum Presentation Prize (\$100)

Mar 2023

Council of Graduate Students – Career Development Grant (\$350)

Mar 2023

Psychology Department Graduate Research Forum: 2nd place (\$250)

Nov 2022

Decision Sciences Collaborative – Small Research Grant (\$3,000)

Nov 2021

*Antecedents of Abstinence and Balancing in Self-Control***Awardee**; co-author: Kentaro Fujita

Psychology Department SBS Graduate Scholarship Award (\$5,760; summer funding)

May 2021

Psychology Department Conference Presentation (\$2,000 total; \$500 per academic year)

2018-2024

Dean's Distinguished University Fellowship (\$100,200 over 3 years)

Aug 2018

University at Buffalo

Undergraduate Excellence in Research, Scholarship and Creativity

Apr 2017

Psi Chi National Psychology Honor Society

Mar 2017

Center for Undergraduate Research and Creative Activities Grant (\$500)	Nov 2016
UB Pride & Service Award	Apr 2016
Phi Beta Kappa Honor Society	Feb 2016
Grace W. Capen Academic Award (\$200)	May 2015
International Student Scholarship (\$32,000 over 4 years)	Aug 2013

PUBLICATIONS

* denotes shared first authorship. Working manuscripts available upon request.

Le, P.Q.*, Nguyen, T.*, Scholer, A.A., & Fujita, K. (in press). Beliefs about using construal level to modulate regulatory scope. *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin*.

Fujita, K., Lapka, S.P., & **Le, P.Q.** (in press). Lay beliefs about willpower and abstinence in self-control. In E.R. Hirt (Ed.), *Handbook of Motivation and Social Psychology*. Elgar Publishing.

Le, P.Q., & Fujita, K. (2025). Matching construal level to regulatory scope in persuasion. In J.D. Teeny, A. Luttrell, and R.E. Petty (Eds.), *The Handbook of Personalized Persuasion: Theory and Application*. Taylor & Francis, Routledge.

Le, P.Q., Scholer, A.A., & Fujita, K. (2024). The role of conflict representation in abstinence and moderation in self-control. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, 126(6), 947–977. <https://doi.org/10.1037/pspa0000381> [Coverage: [Psychology Today](#)]

Fujita, K., **Le, P.Q.**, Scholer, A.A., & Miele, D.B. (2024). The metamotivation approach: Insights into the regulation of motivation and beyond. *Social and Personality Psychology Compass*, 18(2), Article e12937. <https://doi.org/10.1111/spc3.12937>

Le, P.Q., Saltsman, T.L., Seery, M.D., Ward, D., Kondrak, C.L., & Lamarche, V.M. (2019). When a smaller self means manageable obstacles: Spontaneous self-distancing predicts divergent effects of awe during a subsequent performance stressor. *Journal of Experimental Social Psychology*, 80, 59-66. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jesp.2018.07.010>

Manuscripts Under Review & In Progress

Le, P.Q., Fujita K., Lile, J., & Scholer, A.A. (under review). A tradeoff framework of abstinence and moderation in self-control. Invited submission, following accepted proposal at *Current Directions in Psychological Science*.

Le, P.Q., Stanczak, O.J., Hildebrand, L.K., Wallace, L.E., Berkman, E.T., & Fujita, K. (under review). A case study for optimizing research paradigms: The within-subjects effect of temporal distance on language abstraction. Preprint: https://osf.io/9uyh8_v1.

Ross, J., Nguyen, T., **Le, P.Q.**, Scholer, A.A., & Fujita, K. (under review). Beliefs about the motivational benefits of positive and negative feedback in goal pursuit.

Le, P.Q.*, Smith, B.J.*, Nguyen, T., Wilson, S., Cheung, B., Fujita, K., & Berkman, E.T. Reappraisal messaging is more negative and less acceptable to smokers than high-level construal messaging.

Le, P.Q., Libby, L.K., Stewart-Hill, S.A., Ivy, V., & Eibach, R.P. Functions of storyteller's mental visual perspective in social communication.

Desai, N., **Le, P.Q.**, Stillman, P.E., Fujita, K., & Krajbich, I. Diffusion modeling reveals that higher level construal reduces the positive categorical evaluation of immediate rewards in intertemporal choice.

Select Projects in Progress

Le, P.Q., Wang, J., & Fishbach, A. Goal harmony eases goal transitions.

Le, P.Q., Fujita, K., Berkman, E.T., & Scholer, A.A. Goal moralization promotes preference for abstinence in self-control and public policy.

Lapka, S.P.*, **Le, P.Q.***, Xu, M.*, & Fujita, K. Lay people conceptualize self-control as abstinence.

Dillman-Hasso, N.H., **Le, P.Q.**, Shaffer-Morrison, C.D., Fujita, K., Wilson, R. Using narratives to promote goal reflection and pro-environmental behavioral intentions. *Funded by the Foundation for Food and Agriculture Research ACTION program (May 2023, awarded to RW)*

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Symposia Organized

Fujita, K., & **Le, P.Q.** (2024, October). *Challenging Traditions in Self-Regulation Research*. Symposium presented at the Annual Conference of the Society of Experimental Social Psychology, Santa Fe, NM.

Le, P.Q., & Yang, Z. (2024, April). *Challenges, Consequences, and Strategies for Discussing Interpersonal and Social Issues*. Symposium presented at the Annual Conference of the Midwestern Psychological Association, Chicago, IL.

Stewart-Hill, S.A., **Le, P.Q.**, & Libby, L.K., (2024, February). *Communicating with Images: Sociocognitive Functions of Visible and 'Invisible' Imagery*. Symposium presented at the Annual Conference of the Society of Personality and Social Psychology, San Diego, CA.

Le, P.Q., & Fujita, K. (2023, April). *The Antecedents, Consequences, and Resolution of Goal Conflicts*. Symposium at the Annual Conference of the Midwestern Psychological Association, Chicago, IL.

Conference Talks

Le, P.Q., Scholer, A.A., & Fujita, K. (2024, October). The role of conflict representation in abstinence and moderation in self-control. In K. Fujita & P.Q. Le (Co-organizers), *Challenging*

- Traditions in Self-Regulation Research*. Talk presented at the Annual Conference of the Society of Experimental Social Psychology, Santa Fe, NM.
- Le, P.Q.**, Libby, L.K., Ivy, V., & Eibach, R.P. (2024, April). Functions of storyteller's mental imagery perspective in sharing experienced discrimination. In P.Q. Le & Z. Yang (Co-organizers), *Challenges, Consequences, and Strategies for Discussing Interpersonal and Social Issues*. Talk presented at the Annual Conference of the Midwestern Psychological Association, Chicago, IL.
- Le, P.Q.**, Libby, L.K., Ivy, V., & Eibach, R.P. (2024, February). The role of storyteller's mental imagery perspective in sharing experienced discrimination. In S.A. Stewart-Hill, P.Q. Le, & L.K. Libby (Co-organizers), *Communicating with Images: Sociocognitive Functions of Visible and 'Invisible' Imagery*. Talk presented at the Annual Conference of the Society of Personality and Social Psychology, San Diego, CA.
- Le, P.Q.**, Scholer, A.A., & Fujita, K. (2023, April). The role of conflict representation in abstinence and moderation in self-control. In P.Q. Le & K. Fujita (Co-organizers), *The Antecedents, Consequences, and Resolution of Goal Conflicts*. Talk presented at the Annual Conference of the Midwestern Psychological Association, Chicago, IL.
- Le, P.Q.**, Scholer, A.A., & Fujita, K. (2023, March). *Inferring mental representations of self-control conflict from abstinence vs. moderation*. Talk presented at the Spring Research Forum of the OSU Decision Sciences Collaborative, Columbus, OH.
- Le, P.Q.**, Libby, L.K., Ivy, V., & Eibach, R.P. (2023, February). *The role of storyteller's mental imagery perspective in sharing experienced discrimination*. Talk presented at the Shared Reality Preconference in the Annual Conference of the Society of Personality and Social Psychology (Virtual meeting).
- Libby, L.K., **Le, P.Q.**, Ivy, V., Valenti, G., & Eibach, R.P. (2022, October). *Picturing events from a third-person perspective can dampen or heighten emotional response in both the self and others by highlighting an event's bigger meaning*. Invited talk at the Annual Meeting of the Society of Experimental Social Psychology, Philadelphia, PA.
- Le, P.Q.**, Fujita, K., & Scholer, A.A. (2022, May). *Conflict representation predicts abstinence and moderation in self-control*. Talk presented at the Annual Conference of the Society for the Science of Motivation, Chicago, IL.
- Le, P.Q.**, Nguyen, T. & Fujita, K. (2021, May). *Using machine learning to validate a within-subjects construal level manipulation*. Talk presented at the Distances in Organization workshop (Virtual meeting).
- Le, P.Q.**, & Libby, L.K. (2021, April). *Visual perspective in mental imagery influences people's language style*. Talk presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwestern Psychological Association (Virtual meeting).
- Le, P.Q.**, & Fujita, K. (2021, February). *Perceived goal conflict type influences when people prefer abstinence vs. balancing*. Talk presented at the Judgment Decision-Making Preconference in the Annual Meeting of the Society of Personality and Social Psychology (Virtual meeting).

Le, P.Q., & Libby, L.K. (2020, May). *Perspective as a communication tool: Third-person imagery facilitates analytical language.* Talk presented at the Distances in Organization workshop (Virtual meeting).

Le, P.Q., & Libby, L.K. (2020, April). *Perspective as a writing tool: Third-person imagery facilitates analytical language.* Talk presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwestern Psychological Association, Chicago, IL (Conference canceled).

Le, P.Q., Saltsman, T.L., Seery, M.D., Ward, D., Kondrak, C.L., & Lamarche, V.M. (2019, April). *When a small self means manageable obstacles: Spontaneous self-distancing predicts divergent effects of awe during a subsequent performance stressor.* Talk presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwestern Psychological Association, Chicago, IL.

Le, P.Q., Saltsman, T.L., & Seery, M.D. (2017, April). *Testing the effects of awe on individual goal pursuit: A psychophysiological approach.* Talk presented at the University at Buffalo Women in STEM Cooperative's "STEM for Everyone" Event, Buffalo, NY.

Posters & Other Presentations

Le, P.Q., Scholer, A.A., & Fujita, K. (2023, February). *Conflict representation predicts abstinence and moderation in self-control.* Poster presented at the Annual Conference of the Society of Personality and Social Psychology, Atlanta, GA.

Le, P.Q., Fujita, K., & Scholer, A.A. (2022, May). *Conflict representation predicts abstinence and moderation in self-control.* Poster presented at the Spring Research Forum of the OSU Decision Sciences Collaborative, Columbus, OH.

Le, P.Q., Libby, L.K., Morewedge, C.K., Eibach, R.P., & Rha, J.J. (2020, February). *Repeated imagined food consumption's effect on actual desire to consume depends on visual perspective.* Poster presented at the Annual Meeting of the Society of Personality and Social Psychology, New Orleans, LA.

Le, P.Q., Saltsman, T.L., Seery, M.D., Ward, D., Kondrak, C.L., & Lamarche, V.M. (2019, February). *When a small self means manageable obstacles: Spontaneous self-distancing predicts divergent effects of awe during a subsequent performance stressor.* Poster presented at the Motivation Science Preconference at the Annual Meeting of the Society of Personality and Social Psychology, Portland, OR.

Le, P.Q., Saltsman, T.L., Seery, M.D., Ward, D., Kondrak, C.L., & Lamarche, V.M. (2018, June). *When a small self means manageable obstacles: Spontaneous self-distancing predicts divergent effects of awe during a subsequent performance stressor.* Poster presented at the seventh Annual Psychology Graduate Student Association Behavior & Brain Sciences Symposium, Buffalo, NY.

Le, P.Q., Saltsman, T.L., Seery, M.D., Ward, D., Kondrak, C.L., & Lamarche, V.M. (2017, August). *When a smaller self means bigger obstacles: Spontaneous self-distancing predicts divergent outcomes of awe during individual goal pursuit.* Poster presented at the Annual Conference of Social Psychologists Around Western New York, Rochester, NY.

Le, P.Q., Saltsman, T.L., & Seery, M.D. (2017, April). *Testing the effects of awe on individual goal pursuit: A psychophysiological approach*. Poster presented at the University at Buffalo Celebration of Academic Excellence, Buffalo, NY.

TEACHING

University of Virginia, Frank Batten School of Leadership and Public Policy

Instructor of Record, LPPL2600: Foundations of Behavioral Science (47 students) Spring 2025

The Ohio State University, Department of Psychology

Instructor of Record, PSYCH3325: Introduction to Social Psychology (79 students) Fall 2021

University at Buffalo

Teaching Assistant, Department of Psychology

PSY411: Topics in Psychology – Self & Self-Esteem (50 students) Spring 2017

PSY101: Introduction to Psychology (450 students) Fall 2015

PSY250: Scientific Inquiries (18 students) Summer 2015

Academic Tutor, Academic Services, Division of Athletics 2016 – 2017

MENTORING

Research Mentees at University of Chicago

Linjin Hu (2025-)

Jenny Zhong (2025-)

Andrea Rivera-Martinez (2025-)

Research Mentees at University of Virginia

Amira Dennis (2024-2025)

Ayat Younis (2024-2025)

Research Mentees at The Ohio State University

Rupal Mahajan (2024-2025)

Hannah Baltes (2020-2022)

Vidhur Narayan (2022-2024)

Tiffany Chen (2021-2022)

Nken Ntati (2023-2024)

Erik Portillo (2020-2021)

Yixin Zhang (2023-2024)

Kali Bruns (2020-2022)

Patrick Duffy (2023-2023)

Riley Bragg (2019-2020)

Dominic Frazee-Crawford (2022-2023)

Ivana Mijatovic (2020-2021)

Shanelle White (2023-2023)

Abigail Hartsell (2019-2020)

Shaojia Ma (2022-2023)

Luna Luo (2019-2019)

Raymond Ko (2022-2023)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Ad Hoc Reviewer

Motivation Science; Perspectives on Psychological Science; Social and Personality Psychology
Compass; Social Psychological and Personality Science

Service at University of Chicago Booth School of Business

Roman Family Center for Decision Research, Mindworks Chief Scientist

2025-Present

Service at Ohio State Department of Psychology

Social Area Colloquium Chair	2022-2023
Social Behavior Interest Group President	2022-2023
Social Cognition Interest Group President	2022-2023
Social Area Recruitment Coordinator	2020-2021, 2021-2022
Social Cognition Interest Group Treasurer	2021-2022, 2023-2024
Social Area & Department Diversity Committee Member	2020-2021
Social Area First-year Events Coordinator	2019-2020

Other Service

SCP 2026 Conference Reviewer	2025
SPSP Outstanding Research Award Reviewer	2020

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Methods: Experiments; Survey design; Protocol and research material development; Focus groups

Advanced statistics and modeling: Mixed-effects or multilevel modeling; Natural language processing; Supervised machine learning; Drift diffusion modeling

Software: Qualtrics, Git, Pavlovia, PsychoPy3, MediaLab & DirectRT

Computation: R, SPSS, Python, JavaScript/jsPsych, HTML/CSS, Matlab